Problem–Solution Fit / ServiceNow Project Journey

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

DATE	TEAM ID	PLATFORM	AUTOMATION	SERVICE	PROCESS
Oct 2026	6ab75a49da631abbf0cded44	ServiceNow	Flow Designer	Standard Laptop	Procurement → Approval → Hardware

PROBLEM
Manual standard-laptop configuration creates delays, oversight, user frustration and inefficient IT resource allocation.

USER STORY
As IT procurement, streamline standard laptop ordering so configuration tasks are automatically generated and assigned to Hardware.

PROJECT OBJECTIVE
Automate procurement/configuration to reduce manual intervention and errors, improve task allocation, reduce user wait time and increase productivity.

SUCCESS / OUTCOME
Approved requests create a Hardware Catalog Task with the required description, assignment group and approval condition.

	ENTICE Need identified	ENTER Open ServiceNow	ENGAGE Order + approval	FULFILL Hardware task	EXIT Status verified	EXTEND Reusable automation
STEPS	Identify the need for a standard laptop.	ServiceNow → Service Catalog → Hardware → Standard Laptop → Order Now.	Request is approved; Flow Designer creates the Catalog Task.	Catalog Task is assigned to Hardware for laptop configuration.	Open Requested Item → Catalog Tasks and verify the updated task/status.	Reuse the automated pattern for future standard procurement requests.
INTERACTIONS / TOUCHPOINTS	Requester, IT procurement team and ServiceNow request.	Standard Laptop catalog item and order interface.	Approval record, Requested Item and Flow Designer.	Catalog Task, Hardware assignment group and configuration team.	Requested Item and Catalog Task status/details.	Repeatable ServiceNow workflow for IT procurement operati
GOALS & MOTIVATIONS	Help me start the standard laptop request.	Help me submit the correct catalog request.	Help me get approval-to-task handoff automated.	Help me ensure Hardware receives clear work.	Help me confirm the task has been created and updated.	Help me reduce waiting, manual effort and administrative overhead.
POSITIVE MOMENTS	Clear entry point for a standard request.	Consistent Standard Laptop catalog path.	Task creation occurs automatically after approval.	Hardware receives defined assignment and configuration details.	Request and task progress can be checked.	Improved efficiency, resource allocation and user experience
NEGATIVE / FRICTION	Manual procurement can delay configuration.	Users must navigate ServiceNow catalog steps.	Manual approval-to-task handoff can be missed or delayed.	Manual assignment increases effort and potential errors.	Users may wait while configuration is coordinated.	Manual steps limit procurement efficiency.
AREAS OF OPPORTUNITY	Make standard laptop requests easier to initiate.	Keep the standard item and request path consistent.	Create the right task automatically after approval.	Ensure required task fields and Hardware assignment are populated.	Make request/task verification simple.	Extend the automation pattern to other standard procurement services.

IMPLEMENTATION ESSENTIALS Flow: “Standard Laptop Task” • Application: Global • Run as: System user • Trigger: Service Catalog • Action: Create Catalog Task • Request item: Requested Item Record • Short description/description: “Laptop need to Configured” • Assignment group: Hardware • Approval: Approved • Flow attached to Standard Laptop catalog item.

VALIDATION / COMPLETION Order Standard Laptop → check Order status → open Request Number → Approvers → Approve → Requested Item → Catalog Tasks → verify updated short description, Assignment group and task status. Conclusion: automation reduces manual overhead, supports timely configuration and improves productivity.